



iCloud Keychain Chrome

iCloud Keychain is coming to Chrome for the first time, letting users manage their Apple passwords. <http://dgit.in/feb21-47>



Plex Arcade

Plex Labs partners with Atari to bring retro gaming to its platform; users can host their own game ROMs too. <http://dgit.in/feb21-48>



Delving into the logic board

The next component to come out are the two logic boards. The chips housed on these boards include the STMicroelectronics STM32L496QG 32-Bit Arm Microcontroller, Apple 343S00404 Bluetooth SoC (rumoured to be the H1 chip on each side of the headset), Winbond W25Q256JW 256 Mb Serial Flash Memory, Cirrus Logic CS46L10A0 Audio Codec, and others. There are actually a ton of chips on the silicone. Check out iFixit's full teardown to see what all of them are.



Apple
AirPods
Max



Intricately-built headband hinge

Apple employs an intricately-built electromechanical hinge hardware that allows the seemingly delicate hinge to tilt and spin freely but still feel robust. The company has used a wraparound flex cable in the rotating portion of this hinge and added some built-in strain relief as well. The joint is held together by a couple of T4, T3, T2 and even T1 screws. There are two large springs within that provide the clamping force of the headset while two smaller springs allow one of the best things possible for reparability. Inserting just a SIM card removal tool or paperclip into the right place in the headband can detach it completely from the ear cups! The tool basically compresses the two tiny springs inside the joint and frees the clamp from the headband!



Modular Lightning port

The Lightning port is held down by four Torx screws, two of which are extremely hard to reach. The folks over at iFixit needed to daisy-chain a T2 Torx bit into a 4 mm nut driver to reach into the tiny space. Still, the port's modularity is critical for easy repairs. There are also plastic air channels on both ear cups which allows air to flow through to allow the drivers to provide an oomph even at higher volume levels, without distortion.



Images courtesy:

Website: iFixit.com

Teardown link: <http://dgit.in/AirPodsMax>